Looking Up, Putting Off

Because believers have been raised with Christ, their life hidden with Him in God, they are to keep seeking and setting their minds on things above — and to bring their practice up to their position by putting off the old actions, attitudes and lies. Christ is all, and in all.

Where this study fits

Colossians · twelve studies · this study highlighted

01 1:1–8 **Faith, Love, and Hope in Colossae**	**02 1:9–14** **Paul's Prayer for the Colossians**	**03 1:15–23** **The Savior of the Gospel**	**04 1:24–29** **Christ in You, the Hope of Glory**
05 2:1–7 **The Believer's Education**	**06 2:8–15** **Beware of Philosophy**	**07 2:16–23** **Run the Race Set Before You**	**08 3:1–11** **Looking Up, Putting Off**
09 3:12–17 **Service Manual for the Lord's Army**	**10 3:18–4:1** **The Relationships of the New Man**	**11 4:2–6** **Perfecting the Prayer Life**	**12 4:7–18** **Portrait of a Ministry Team**

The life that looks up to Christ

Colossians 3:1–4 · Outline I.A–D

Requirement	“If (since) you have been raised up with Christ” — you need the Christian life before you can live it	**συνεγείρω** first class condition (2:12)
v.1b	Keep seeking the things above, where Christ is seated at God’s right hand (Ps 110:1)	**ζητέω** Pres. Impv. — the will
v.2	Set your mind on the things above, not on the things on earth (cf. Phil 4:8)	**φρονέω** Pres. Impv. — the mind
v.3	Reason: you died, and your life is hidden with Christ in God	**κρύπτω** Perf. — concealed and safe
v.4	Reward: when Christ, our life, is revealed, you will be revealed with Him in glory	**φανερόω** made visible

The things above, already named: the canceled debt (2:14), the treasures in Christ (2:3), the Head’s supply (2:19).

Put to death the old actions

Colossians 3:5–7 · Outline II — From the specific to the comprehensive

1 Immorality

πορνεία
Every kind of sexual sin

2 Impurity

ἀκαθαρσία
Sexual uncleanness of a wider kind

3 Passion

πάθος
Uncontrolled lust that goes looking for temptation

4 Evil desire

ἐπιθυμία κακή
Craving for the forbidden (1 Pet 1:14)

5 Greed

πλεονεξία
The itch to have more — “which amounts to idolatry” (Exod 20:17)

✓ How to avoid them

Call sin by its name · send no wrong signals · think proper thoughts · stay out of compromise · flee (1 Cor 6:18)

Put aside the old attitudes

Colossians 3:8 · Outline III — “From your mouth”

Anger	A settled, abiding attitude of anger, often with a desire for revenge	**ὀργή** the settled condition
Wrath	The boiling over — an outburst of rage	**θυμός** boiling agitation
Malice	Mean-spirited ill will that wants to harm — the root beneath anger and rage	**κακία** desire to injure
Slander	Abusive speech that defames and denigrates others	**βλασφημία** defaming speech
Abusive speech	Low, obscene, foul-mouthed language	**αἰσχρολογία** only here in the NT

“Put them all aside” — like taking off old clothes. What the heart holds, the mouth eventually speaks.

Put away the old lie

Colossians 3:9–11 · Outline IV — The inconsistency and impossibility of the lie

Old self — laid aside
ἀπεκδύομαι · Aor. · v.9

Who we were in Adam

Put off at salvation — a past fact

Its evil practices no longer fit

New self — put on
ἀνακαινόω · Pres. Pass. · v.10

Being renewed continually

“To a true knowledge” (epignōsis, 1:9)

According to the image of the Creator (Gen 1:27–28; Heb 2:8–9)

No elite in Christ
v.11

Racial: Greek and Jew

Religious: circumcised and not

Cultural: barbarian, Scythian

Social: slave and freeman

“Christ is all, and in all.” No one has more of Christ than anyone else — the question is how much of me He has.

Discuss and apply

Colossians 3:1–11 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. Why must a person be “raised with Christ” before he can obey 3:1–2?

2. What does “Christ is all, and in all” mean for how we treat other believers?

Apply

Retrain Your Thought Life
Replace fifteen minutes of screen time each day this week with meditating on Colossians 3:1–4.

Let Christ Have All of You
Write down one area you have held back from Christ and pray daily, “Lord, have all of me here.”

In one line: Look up, then take off the old clothes: bring your practice up to your position, because Christ is all, and in all.